



SAFE HAVEN TIMES



Spring 2026

A Life Saved - Nellie's Story

"Yes" was the answer Safe Haven Manager, Jeannette McCullum, gave to the staff member of Veterinary Associates who was on the other end of the line. In doing so, a precious life was saved.

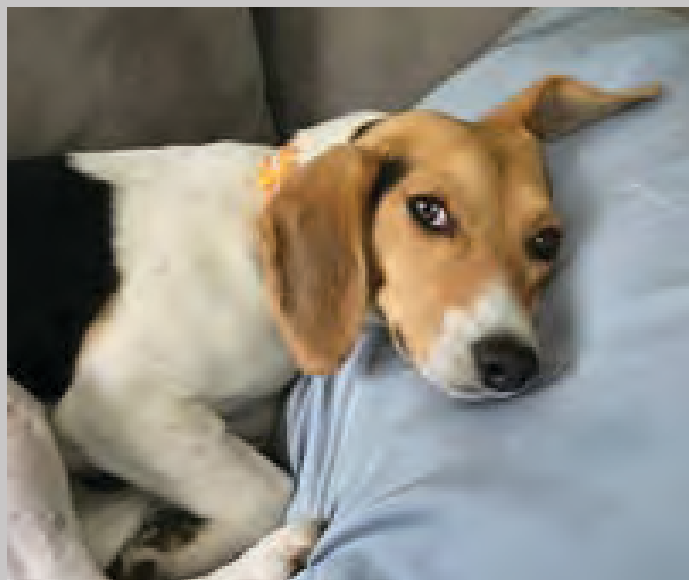
On the evening of April 3rd, Nellie the beagle was brought to Vet Associates in Galena with a compound fracture of her right femur. This was the result of being accidentally run over by an ATV on the owners property. After the extent of her injuries were known, the owner declined treatment in favor of euthanizing the small dog.

Because of Safe Haven's long relationship with Vet Associates, staff there contacted Jeannette and Safe Haven President, Sam Smith, to ask if we would intervene. It was immediately decided that Safe Haven would assume responsibility for Nellie and foot the bill for reconstructive surgery. Dr. Dulce Coulson, who is the lead veterinarian for Safe Haven's low-cost spay/neuter clinic, performed surgery and repaired Nellie's leg with

a plate and 10 screws. Following a short recovery at the vet clinic, Nellie was placed in foster with volunteer Rachel O'Brien for a period estimated at 8 weeks to recover.

Three weeks after surgery, we are thrilled to report that Nellie is doing very well. Foster Mom Rachel says that in typical beagle fashion, Nellie is very active and is making progress daily. Nellie is expected to be available for adoption in June.

The cost of Nellie's surgery and follow-up care have been substantial as well as unexpected. If you would like to make a donation towards these costs and become part of Nellie's life-saving story, please use the QR code on the back cover of this newsletter, visit our website at www.safehavenforpets.org, call the shelter at 815-858-2265 to donate via phone, or send a check to Safe Haven at 1471 US Highway 20 West, Elizabeth, IL 61028. Please include Nellie's name in the gift memo.



Just look at this sweet face!



Nellie will need a TSA screening card should she ever fly!

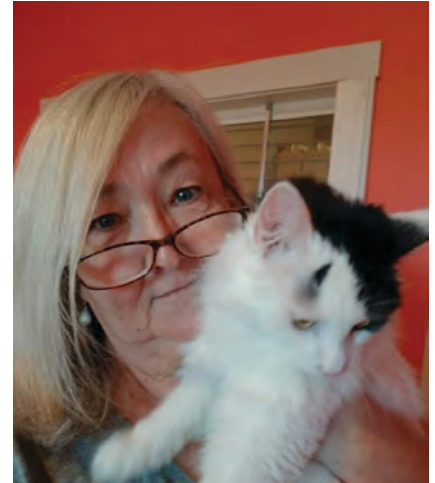
Our Amazing Team!



Jeannette Thraen McCullum
Shelter Manager



Anne Marie James
Bookkeeper



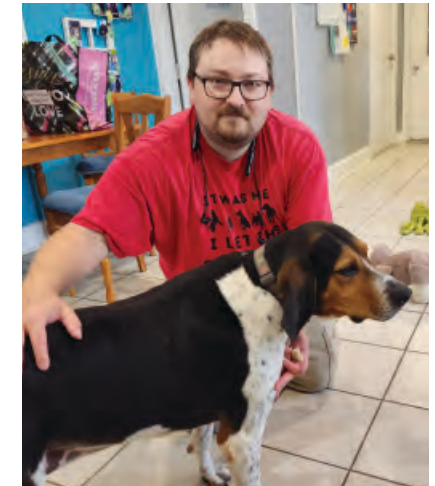
Cher Dyle
Volunteer Coordinator



Taylor Edler
Veterinary Assistant



Amanda Kautz
Foster Coordinator



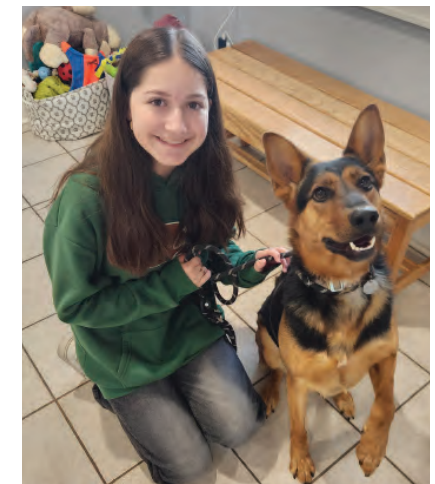
Andrew Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Kristin Roos Barlow
Shelter Assistant



Wendy Marcotte
Shelter Assistant



Allie Velazquez
Shelter Assistant

From the President

FIFTEEN YEARS OF A LOVE RELATIONSHIP

My association with Safe Haven began in 2011. My wife, Lynda, and I had planned a four-day trip to Eagle Ridge. My intent was to play golf several times during this stay. Well, it rained for four straight days, ruining my plans. As it turned out, this inconvenience resulted in a serendipitous event. While debating what to do with our time, we saw an ad in the Territory Times for a cat named Prudence.

We made a trip to the shelter to meet her but were disappointed by her reluctance to engage with us. As we spent more time in the room with the seven cats who resided there, we fell in love with Louie, a big gray boy. My wife felt very bad for Latte, a little tuxedo girl who stayed to herself and didn't come out of her wall-mounted milk crate.

A week later Louie and Latte were in our home back in Bloomington. Louie adapted well, but Latte seemed overwhelmed. As weeks went by, she gradually became more comfortable in our home. Louie loved heights and any object that allowed him to be in an enclosed space. Latte was very much at home in boxes.

They moved with us to The Galena Territory in 2017. We spent quite a bit of time volunteering at the shelter, and I joined the board of directors in 2018. While we lived in The Territory, Latte suffered a health setback that included ataxia. She was sequestered in one bedroom and gradually regained motor skills. She did appear to lose hearing.

We moved to Normal in 2021 and the cats adjusted well to their new home. Unfortunately, both passed away in the summer of 2023. While Lynda felt it was too soon to bring another cat into our home, I fell in love with Blueberry during a trip to Safe Haven. After I had a very bad auto wreck, Lynda had to drive me to Elizabeth for a board meeting. That day Lynda met Blueberry, and he went home with us that night.

After serving as Treasurer for a couple of years, I subsequently became President of the Board of Directors. With the many Saturdays when we have clinics or pet food distributions and the monthly board meetings, I drive the 380-mile round trip 3 to 5 times each month. I do this because of the great work Safe Haven does to make the lives of animals and their owner/care-takers better. I have met many wonderful people who love and care for animals in the area.

I truly feel privileged to be affiliated with Safe Haven and intend to retain this relationship as long as I am able. I am truly humbled to be part of an organization that provides so much help to all the people who depend on us.

Sam

Sam Smith
Board President



Sam and friend at the shelter.

Breaking News!



Latest Adoption Numbers

Dogs adopted as of April 30, 2026:

14

Cats adopted as of April 30, 2026:

35

With hopes to increase cat and dog adoptions by having more weekend hours, Safe Haven is now open for business on Sundays from 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM. We will close to the public on Mondays and re-open Tuesdays through Saturdays from 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM. Stop by to visit us and our pets!

Safe Haven Thanks the 2025 *Birdies for Charity* Supporters

Birdies for Charity is a major fundraising program that runs as part of the PGA John Deere Classic held annually in the Quad Cities. It allows donors to pledge money per birdie made by professionals or make a flat donation. Participating charities receive 100% of donations plus a bonus match. Safe Haven has been a participating charity for many years and it is a great opportunity for our supporters to have their donations matched up what 7%. If you have not received your Birdies pledge form, please contact the shelter.

Karen Aldrich
David Anderson
Mary Brandt
Eugene Champion
Jennie K. Cliff
Dab Consedine
John & Nancy Danico
John & Kay Day
Clyde & Karen Eggett
Karen Gorozowski
Karen Hutchings
Barb Jansz
Suzy Kania

Deb Kelly
John Klinkner
Mark Linton
John & Rose Lorenzen
Linda Malia
Patricia McGarvey
Steve Meyer
Diane O'Dell
Steven Paulson
Jeni Pearce
Deborah Powers
Jan & Bill Price
Susan & Tim Rapinchuk

Traci Schmitt
Cammie & Gary Seamans
Dan Smith
Marilyn Spiroff
Ken Thompson
Linda Weeder
Kathleen Weyna
Michael Whitmarsh
Jim Wills
Jack Woodard
Ken & Lynn Zehnder
Sheila Zink

Safe Haven Out & About

After many years of teaching the early childhood character development class, Kindhearted Kids, in local elementary schools, Tricia Bianchetto, former Safe Haven Board Chair and volunteer, passed the baton to Linda Schafer, who wrote this about her new role.

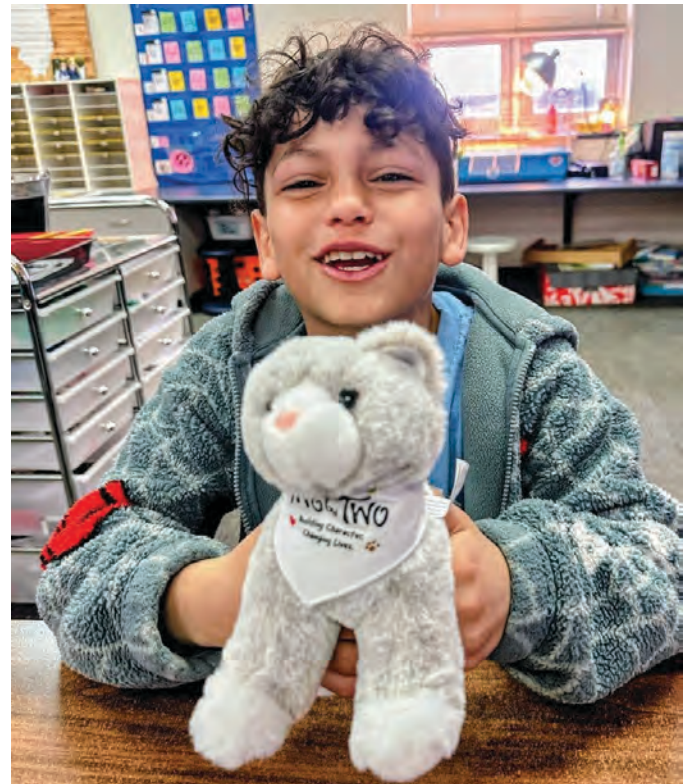
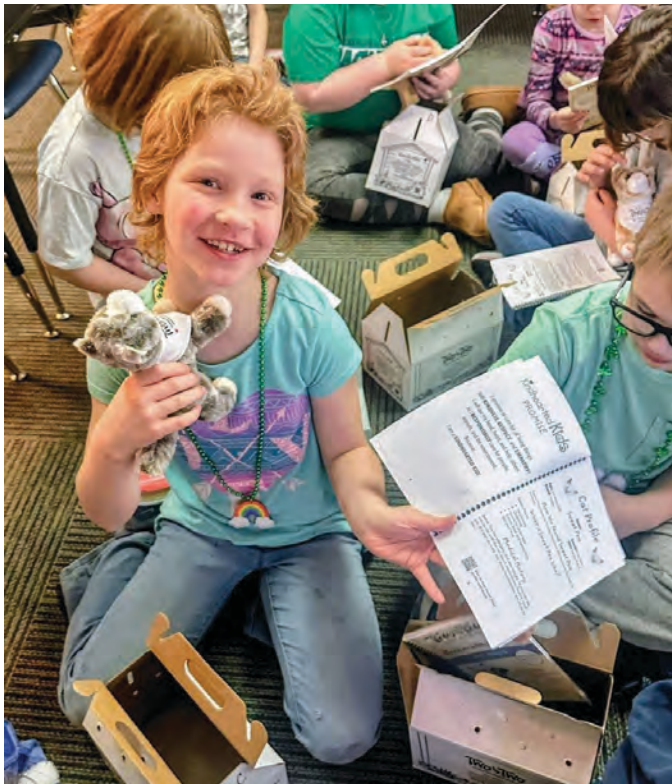
"I became involved with Kindhearted Kids when Jeannette McCullum, Shelter Manager, contacted me last November and asked if I was interested in working with Safe Haven as a teacher for the program. I had recently retired from River Ridge Elementary School and Jeannette's son, Will, was in my last class. So she knew I was available and that I loved animals.

"The program is designed for lower elementary students. The program uses character-focused lessons to teach kindness, respect, responsibility, empathy, cooperation, perseverance, and citizenship. These lifelong skills are taught through the

compassion and care of animals.

"I visit the second grade classes at River Ridge and Scales Mound twice a week over a period of 5 weeks. The first lesson is so exciting as each student is presented with an adorable stuffed dog or cat in its own cardboard carrier. Each pet is named and has a story with it, including its age, breed, history, and any special needs. The students also receive a Kindhearted Kids journal in which they complete adventure goals after each lesson.

I am loving being a part of this program! The second graders are so fun to work with, and are totally engaged in every lesson. They are excited to participate in every activity and are doing such a wonderful job caring for their pets. I feel very blessed to be able to be a part of this valuable program."



The magical journey of becoming a kindhearted kid begins with the adoption of a stuffed dog or cat. The pets immediately spark children's attention, capture their hearts, and positive life-long skills easily take root!

Some of Our Amazing Volunteers in Action!

The Heartbeat of Our Shelter: 4,289 Reasons to Say Thank You

If you've walked through the shelter recently, you've likely felt a certain energy—a mix of wagging tails, purring engines, and the tireless dedication of the humans who make it all happen. Today, we are thrilled to share a milestone that truly defines the spirit of our community.

In 2025, our incredible team of volunteers donated over 4,000 service hours to the animals in our care.

Those hours weren't just spent "hanging out" with cute pets (though there was plenty of that!). Our volunteers were on the front lines every single day:

- **Morning Walks:** Ensuring every dog started their day with fresh air and exercise.
- **Socialization & Enrichment:** Helping shy

cats find their confidence and teaching "old dogs" new tricks.

- **Behind-the-Scenes Heroics:** From cleaning cat condos, picking up in the exercise yards, assisting at adoption events or staffing the clinic, to name just a few.

Every hour donated represents a life changed. Because of this monumental effort, our residents were more socialized, our facilities stayed cleaner, and—most importantly—more animals found their "forever" homes maybe a little faster.

To our volunteers: You are the true heroes of 2025. Whether you gave one hour or one hundred, you made a world of difference.

Inspired by these numbers? We're always looking for new faces to help us beat our record in 2026! Find more information at safehavenforpets.org.

~ Cher Dyle, Safe Haven Volunteer Coordinator



Handyman Norm is always busy making sure our shelter looks great.



Kayla regularly volunteers to take our dogs for car rides.



Volunteer Andi helping out on a Saturday morning.

Volunteer Hours Update

Total volunteer hours
as of April 30, 2026:
1,395

Month with the most hours:
February/431

Our amazing volunteer corps continues to donate huge amounts of hours each month and we thank them!



In April, students from Stockton Elementary came to the shelter to read to our cats.



Becca, a 2nd grader at Scales Mound, celebrated her 8th birthday by asking friends to donate to our pets.



Volunteer Wendy helping to clean office space which is currently being used to house an overflow of cats.



Wendy Meyer and Karla Rowles took our huskies for a walk about town during Elizabeth's Spring Fling in May.



The pet food distribution team is ready to go on a recent Saturday morning.

Spay/Neuter Clinic Creating a Better Community

Safe Haven opened its spay/neuter clinic in 2025 with great hopes to help reduce the overpopulation of animals, especially cats, in our communities. This project has been very successful, although there is much to be accomplished.

An overpopulation of animals creates nuisance and potential health issues. The humane and legal solution is to spay or neuter animals. Safe Haven has worked with several cat rescues and many concerned citizens to provide surgery and appropriate treatment for community cats. This has been done at a fraction of industry standard costs, enabling us to perform over 500 surgeries through March of this year.

The clinic operation has been staffed by an outstanding group of professionals and volunteers. Dr. Dulce Coulson has performed most of the surgeries, with Dr. Katie Schneider providing additional help as her schedule allows. Veterinary technicians who have assisted include Danielle Miller, who is our primary, Kate Koester, and Kirsten Isaacson.

We have a great group of volunteers who often work 10 hour days at each clinic. This group includes Katie Hoffman, Amanda Kevern, Jen Berendes, Sue Walker, Mary Hofer Furlong, Deb

Lahre-Joyner, Rachel O'Brien, Brooke Bernard, Meagan Szykowski, Andrea Heidenreich, Nancy Boop, and Jamie Whitmer. This group assists with intake, prepping animals, monitoring vitals, clerical duties, and sterilization of instruments.

We have had many positive responses from clients. We see people who badly want to make the lives of animals better but have limited funds to devote to this cause. One of our clients, Christina Marie Hinshaw offered the following:

"The low cost spay/neuter services Safe Haven has provided are a blessing for those of us looking for low-cost spay/neuter options! They have already helped me get several stray cats in my area fixed, and they have provided such a great service to my neighbors who have reached out to me when they needed to get their pets fixed also."

"While animal rescue will never be easy, having a safe, local, and low-cost place to take these cats to get fixed has been such a stress relief for me personally, and to the community members here in Warren. Thank you, Safe Haven, for your compassion, understanding and your genuine love for both pets and people! You have truly made our community a better place for all of us!"



Our volunteers are amazing! Here Kirk Hoffman comforts a dog awaking after surgery.



Sam Smith and Dr. Dulce Coulson taking a short break during a recent clinic.

Gifts Given In Honor Of

Barb & Les Gack
Hillary Meyer

Our Fur Loving Friends
Dan & Peggy Korth

Gemma & Lily
Beverly Kolz

All the Kenneally cats that
have gone before us
Jennifer Schumacher

Scooter
Patricia A. Meyer

Patricia Woodard
Jack Woodard

Tom & Barb Jansz
Denise & Denny Ertzman

Carol Scarpelli's Birthday
Shirley Ramstedt
Julie Scarpelli

All the animals that need love
Joe & Tina Flynn

Betty White
Richard & Louann Kenney

Lily & Parker
Ken & Marcia Thompson

Gracie, our Safe Haven cat
Julie Bruser & Tom Saccomanno

Jen Berendes
McKenna Altfillisch

John & Kay Day
Carol J. Bunyan

Blu
Melissa Farren

Carol Scarpelli for Christmas
Julie Scarpelli

Our beautiful animals
Dave Hallenbeck & Leslie Foss
David W Hallenbeck Family
Foundation

Myra, now Tora, adopted from Safe
Haven in 2020
Meredith Dillman

Rori & Ridley
Susan & Mike Sostak

Punky
Janet Laue

Otis
Judy Asp

Tango, our orange long haired tabby
kitten, adopted in 2010.
Frank & Sue Caba

Liza, adopted 12/5/2022
Nancy Lee

Gloria Nagel
Maureen Vannucci

Buster and her Papa Rorrie
Bridget Kramer

Biggie
Kimberly Jasper

Joan Hoeper's kitty Boots
The Hoeper Family

Zoey
A.C. Stafanick

Nancy Braus' Birthday
Robyn Braus

Mary Rubel's Birthday
Jane Rubel

Sponsor-A-Pet - Starts at Just \$10/Month!

Your monthly donation of \$10 or more helps to support one of our cats or dogs in the shelter. All major credit cards are accepted. You may cancel at anytime. Please consider joining those who make these contributions by signing up at safehavenforpets.org and scroll down to the bottom of the homepage.

David Anderson
Stephanie Beardsley
Kathleen Behof
Lisa Bourrette
Steve & Trish Bianchetta
Gary Binder
Mary & Brian Brandt
Jackie Buckley
Dan & Connie Consedine
Juanita Cox
John & Kay Day
Cathy Dorwick
Bob & Lu Douglas
Edith Duncan

Steve Efken
Linda & Wilfred Enders
Andrea Garvey
David Gilliland
Larry & Karen Gorczowski
Pam Hall
Bernie & Mary Carol Harris
Debra Huso
Barb Jansz
Richard & Karen Jasper
Shari Kochman
Lucy Koropchuk
Loren Maccario
Pat & Linda Malia

Brittany & Dave Middendorf
Joseph Murnane
Tom & Wallene Neumiller
Donna Pries
James & Ulrike Rachuy
Dana Rowe
Sam & Lynda Smith
The Freckles Foundation/Jeni
Pearce
Doug Troutman
Sue Walker
John & Lisa Wilhelmsen

A Few of Our Happy Tails



Stanley



Goblin



Bruno, on right, with his new sibling.



Kora is all smiles with her new family.



Muffin



Dasher



Sylvester & Penelope



Scout



Dorothy & Aretha

Gifts Given In Memory Of

Sandy Linde
Doris Trader
Steve & Wendy Meyer

Teddy Bear
Eugene Champion

Rusty & Monty
Bev & Wes Mellskog

Tara, Daisy, & Garfield
Edith Duncan

Dan Prather and our dogs
from Safe Haven, Kenda &
Aspen
Marci Prather

All my beloved pets
Carole Andres

Ben & Jerry & Megan
Lyn & Bob Lund

My beloved kitty "Tinsel".
She was the best cat ever!
Mary Brandt

Robert Zink / Rusty & Baron
Sheila Zink

Bill Corbett
Wende Corbett

Dink E. Dog
John & Linda Malia

Dorian, beloved and loving
feline companion of
Elizabeth Boggess
Ras and Jackie, fabulous
mare and her canine
companion
Shari Kochman

Smokie & Lacy, Family Dogs
Jack G. Woodard

Cody
Al Minter

Diane B. Wills
James A. Wills

Thomas J Samocki
Marcia M. Samocki

Zane
Marv & Linda Stewart

Erin A Schoenhard
Ann Schoenhard

Patricia Woodard
Marilyn & Irle Boehm

Millie Wood
Ann Bjerkos

Our beloved cat Aramis
Colin & Flavia Farinha

Chewy, he brought great joy
and love to our lives and will
be forever missed.
Suzanne & Jody Allison's
Family & Nancy Allison
Perkins Foundation

Lucy
Josh Trebian
James & Missy Boho

Freya, my little best friend
Ingrid Tarolla

Dr Wilfred Enders
Jan Kuehl

Cayo
Derinda Valley Landscape

Our beloved Frosty, who we
adopted from Safe Haven in
February 2010.
John & Rosa Lorenzen

Tula LeBowe
Candice LeBowe

Mike Hillard, Galena, Il.
Leigh Ann Eaton

Spike, our Silky Terrier
David & Kathryn Schaller

Rusty, our Golden Chow
boy, adopted in 2003.
Frank & Sue Caba

Phyllis Bertram
Jim Webster
Deborah Pausz

Pepper
David, Gail, & Dori Gilliland

Harvey Glew
Judy Glew

Susan Cain
Shari Kochman
Heidi Moore

Donna Lappen
William & Teri Doran

Pattie Gallwas
Prairie Ridge of Galena

Oliver & Millie, beloved dogs
of Angelica, David, Mason,
and Michael Teply.
Mittie & David Den Herder

Chris Hagemeyer
Stephanie Beck
Diane & Jim Beemster
Carol Hagemeyer
Marjorie Olivier

Joan Hoeper (Mother & MIL
of Will Hoeper & Lori Myers)
The Hoeper Family

Craig Ward
Wendy & Steve Meyer

Joe Offerman
Christine DePilla
Frances O'Keefe
William Riley
Marie Wright & Nancy
Willett

Jean Marie DeNapoli
Ilisa Farrell

Carol Honeywell
Sue & Steve Honeywell

My wonderful companion
Pickles
Allan Mendel

Nate Scarpelli, honorary
board member
Safe Haven Board
Carol & Ray Scarpelli

Hershey who went over the
rainbow bridge on April 20,
2025.
Emily Bush

Larry Backe
Nancy Backe

Thea O'Connor
William & Pamela
O'Connor

Maureen Petry
Steve & Wendy Meyer

Lisa Sargent
Daniel Sargent

In memory of our dear friend,
Bobbie Klein
John & Kay Day

August Vincent Comella, a
lifelong dog lover & friend to
many over the course of 88
years.

Carol K. Comella
Jennifer Foley
Anita Lau
Sue & Tom Moran

Lizzie, a black cocker
spaniel adopted many years
ago by Dave & Debbie
Powers
Sue & Tom Trisch



We try very hard to ensure that our in memory of and in honor of donations are included correctly in our newsletter.

If you made a donation and it was not included or it was misspelled, please send an email to safehavenbook-keeper1471@gmail.com and we will make sure it is corrected in the next issue of our newsletter.



Safe Haven
1471 U.S. Highway 20
Elizabeth, IL 61028
815.858.2265
www.safehavenforpets.org
safehaven1471@gmail.com

Save the Date!

Paws at the Pavilion
Fall Fundraiser
September 19, 2026
Details to come.

Make A Gift Today!

Just point your smartphone camera at the QR code and you will be taken directly to the donation page of the Safe Haven website.

Making a donation is quick and secure.
Safe Haven does not sell, share, or otherwise reveal donor information to any 3rd party.

